

UNFOLD

1. Passage anchor

> “Instead, it **unfolded** quite gently.”

Passage meaning

unfold = gradually develop or reveal itself over time

逐漸展開；慢慢發展；逐步呈現

Here, the book's message is not delivered forcefully or all at once. It becomes clear gradually as the story develops.

Practice

1. The story **unfolds** slowly over several chapters.

故事在幾個章節中**逐漸展開**。

2. The meaning of the novel **unfolded** naturally.

小說的意義很自然地**逐步呈現出來**。

Core meanings of UNFOLD

2. unfold — open something that has been folded

= open out something that was folded so that it becomes flat or fully extended

展開；打開摺疊的東西

Examples

1. She **unfolded the letter** and began to read.

她**展開信紙**開始閱讀。

2. He **unfolded the map** on the table.

他把地圖在桌上**攤開**。

This is the central literal sense.

3. unfold — become open from a folded position

= open out naturally or mechanically from a folded state

****展開；打開****

Examples

1. The chair ****unfolds**** easily.

這張椅子很容易****展開****。

2. The wings ****unfolded**** slowly.

翅膀慢慢****展開****。

Events / story development

4. unfold — develop gradually

= happen or develop gradually, often in a sequence

****逐步發展；逐漸展開****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The events ****unfolded**** over several days.

事情在幾天內****逐步發展****。

2. We watched the situation ****unfold**** in real time.

我們即時看著局勢****逐漸發展****。

5. story / plot unfolds

= narrative gradually develops and reveals what happens

****故事 / 情節逐漸展開****

Examples

1. The plot ****unfolds**** through a series of memories.

情節透過一連串回憶****逐步展開****。

2. As the story ****unfolds****, the characters become more complex.

隨著故事****發展****，人物變得更複雜。

Very high-value literary use.

Reveal / become known

6. unfold — become gradually revealed

= become known, visible, or understandable bit by bit

逐漸揭示；逐步顯現

Examples

1. The truth **unfolded** slowly.

真相慢慢**揭露**出來**。**

2. A more complicated picture began to **unfold**.

一個更複雜的情況開始**逐漸浮現**。

7. unfold a story / account

= reveal or tell something step by step

逐步講述；逐步揭示

Examples

1. She **unfolded the story** carefully.

她仔細地**逐步講述**整件事**。**

2. The documentary **unfolds the history** of the town.

這部紀錄片**逐步呈現**這座城鎮的歷史。

Less common than intransitive **unfold**, but established.

Scene / landscape opening out

8. unfold before someone

= gradually become visible or apparent before someone

在眼前展開；呈現在眼前

Examples

1. A beautiful valley **unfolded before us**.

一座美麗的山谷在我們眼前**展開**。

2. The whole city seemed to **unfold below them**.

整座城市彷彿在他們腳下**展現開來**。

Plan / process becoming clear

9. unfold — become apparent as a process continues

= gradually show its shape, structure, or consequences

逐步顯現；逐漸成形

Examples

1. The plan began to **unfold**.

計畫開始**逐步成形**。

2. The consequences only became clear as events **unfolded**.

只有隨著事情**逐步發展**，後果才變得清楚。

Related forms

10. unfolding — noun/adjective

A. process of development

發展；展開

1. We followed the **unfolding** of events closely.

我們密切關注事件的**發展**。

B. currently developing

正在展開的；正在發展中的

2. The **unfolding crisis** attracted international attention.

這場**正在發展中的危機**引起國際關注。

11. unfolded

= opened out or developed/revealed

****已展開的；已發展 / 揭示的****

Examples

1. The ****unfolded map**** covered the table.

****攤開的地圖****蓋滿了桌面。

2. The events ****unfolded**** unexpectedly.

事情****出乎意料地發展****。

High-value patterns

12. as events unfold

= as a situation continues to develop

****隨著事情發展****

Examples

1. More details will emerge ****as events unfold****.

****隨著事情發展****，會有更多細節出現。

2. We will understand more ****as events unfold****.

****隨著事態發展****，我們會了解更多。

13. watch something unfold

= observe a situation as it develops

****看著某事發展****

Examples

1. Millions watched the rescue ****unfold**** live.

數百萬人即時****看著救援過程發展****。

2. She stood quietly and watched the scene ****unfold****.

她安靜地站著，看著眼前的場面****逐步展開****。

14. let something unfold

= allow a situation or process to develop naturally

****讓某事自然發展****

Examples

1. We decided to let the conversation ****unfold naturally****.

我們決定讓對話****自然發展****。

2. The director lets the story ****unfold slowly****.

導演讓故事****慢慢展開****。

Especially relevant to the passage's ****quite gently****.

Key contrasts

15. unfold vs develop

****develop****

= broad word meaning grow, change, or progress

****發展****

****unfold****

= emphasizes a gradual sequence in which events, meaning, or details become apparent

****逐步展開；逐漸顯現****

Compare:

> The situation developed quickly.

> 情況迅速發展。

> The story unfolded gradually.

> 故事逐步展開，細節慢慢浮現。

16. unfold vs reveal

****reveal****

= make something known or visible

****揭露；揭示****

****unfold****

= often suggests that the revelation happens progressively rather than in one moment

****逐步揭示****

Compare:

> reveal the secret

> 揭露秘密

> the truth unfolds

> 真相一步步浮現

17. unfold vs open

****open****

= make something no longer closed

****打開****

****unfold****

= specifically open something that is folded, or figuratively develop step by step

Compare:

> open the door

> 開門

> unfold the map

> 攤開地圖

18. unfold vs unravel

****unravel****

can mean:

* untangle threads

* solve or explain something complex

****unfold****

= develop or reveal gradually

Compare:

> unravel a mystery

> 解開謎團

> watch the mystery unfold
> 看著謎團相關事件逐步發展

19. unfold vs emerge

****emerge****

= come into view or become known

****浮現；出現****

****unfold****

= emphasizes gradual progression and sequence

Compare:

> a pattern emerged
> 一個模式浮現出來

> the story unfolded
> 故事逐步發展

Meaning map

The central literal concept of ****unfold**** is:

****open something that was folded****

From this develop:

Physical

unfold a map

→ ****攤開地圖****

Natural/mechanical

wings unfold

→ ****翅膀展開****

Then metaphorically:

Events

events unfold

→ **事態逐步發展**

Story

story unfolds

→ **故事逐漸展開**

Meaning/truth

truth unfolds

→ **真相逐步顯現**

Scene

a landscape unfolds before you

→ **景色在眼前展開**

Passage

message unfolds gently

→ **訊息 / 主旨很自然地逐漸呈現**

The passage uses the **gradual development and revelation** branch.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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unfold — open something folded	把摺起的東西展開 / 攤開
unfold — become open	從摺疊狀態逐漸展開
unfold — events develop	事情、局勢等按過程逐步發展
story/plot unfolds	故事或情節隨時間逐步展開
unfold — become revealed	真相、資訊或情況逐步被揭示 / 顯現
unfold a story/account	逐步講述或呈現一件事情
unfold before someone	景象、情況等逐漸在某人眼前展現
plan/process unfolds	計畫、過程或後果逐步成形並顯現
unfolding — development	事件逐步發展 / 展開的過程
unfolding — adjective	正在發展、展開中的
as events unfold	隨著事態一步步發展
watch something unfold	親眼看著某事逐步發展
let something unfold	讓某事按自己的過程自然發展

Passage recap

> “Instead, it **unfolded quite gently**.”

Here, the implied subject is the book’s **message / meaning / idea**.

unfold = **gradually develop and reveal itself rather than being stated directly all at once**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **逐漸展開** *

* **慢慢呈現** *

* **逐步顯現** *

Natural contextual translation:

相反，它的訊息是很溫和地慢慢展開的。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

unfold

= **to gradually develop or become revealed over time**

逐漸展開；逐步發展；慢慢呈現

The key image behind the word is very useful:

> **unfold a map**

> → 把摺好的地圖一層層攤開

figuratively:

> **a story unfolds**

> → 故事像地圖一樣，內容和意義**一層層展開**

So the passage contrasts:

> **hit someone over the head with a message**

> → 很生硬、很直接地把訊息塞給讀者

with:

> **the message unfolds gently**

> → **訊息隨故事自然、逐步地呈現出來**.